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Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

■ Shaikh Mohammad meets with Ahmad Al Sharaa at Qasr Al Shati in Abu Dhabi.

UAE vows support for Syria's development

PRESIDENTS DISCUSS BILATERAL TIES, REGIONAL EVENTS

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received Syrian President Ahmad Al Sharaa, who is on an official visit to the UAE.

The meeting took place yesterday at Qasr Al Shati in Abu Dhabi, where the two leaders discussed the fraternal ties between the UAE and Syria and explored avenues to strengthen cooperation and joint action — particularly in the developmental and economic sectors, in a manner that serves the mutual interests of both nations and brings benefits to their peoples.

They also exchanged views on a range of regional developments and issues of common concern. They underscored the importance of reinforcing

The two leaders underscored the importance of reinforcing the foundations of peace, security, and stability across the Middle East, in support of the region's overall development and the prosperity of its nations and peoples.

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Shaikh Mohammad reaffirmed the UAE's stand in support of Syria and its people, emphasising the UAE's commitment to all efforts that advance Syria's interests and

contribute to realising the aspirations of its people for development, stability, and a prosperous future.

Strengthening the bonds

Al Sharaa expressed his sincere appreciation to Shaikh Mohammad for the UAE's supportive stance towards Syria and its people. He also praised Shaikh Mohammad's dedication to strengthening the bonds of brotherhood between the two nations and wished the UAE continued progress and prosperity.

The Syrian President arrived in Abu Dhabi earlier yesterday and was received at Al Bateen Airport by Shaikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, and a number of senior officials. Al Sharaa was accompanied by Asaad Al Shaibani, Syrian Minister of Foreign Affairs and Expatriates, and several senior officials.

Houthis claim first Red Sea cargo ship attack in months

Yemeni group hit the Greek-owned, Liberian-flagged Magic Seas

SANA'A

Yemen's Houthi rebels claimed responsibility yesterday for an attack that damaged a commercial vessel in the Red Sea and forced its crew to abandon ship, their first such strike in months.

The Iran-backed rebels said they hit the Greek-owned, Liberian-flagged Magic Seas with missiles, drones and uncrewed boats because it had previously docked in Israel.

It was the first Houthi attack on commercial shipping on the vital maritime route this year. In May, the rebels agreed a ceasefire with Wash-

ington that ended weeks of intense US strikes.

The Houthis "targeted the Magic Seas ship ... using two unmanned boats, five ballistic and cruise missiles, and three drones" on Sunday, military spokesman Yahya Saree said in a video statement.

Direct hit

Saree said the ship sustained a direct hit and was at risk of sinking. He said the company's ships were "a legitimate target" because they had done business with Israel and used its ports.

The Houthis have been targeting Israeli territory and commercial vessels in the Red Sea and Gulf of Aden since the Gaza war broke out in October 2023, forcing shipping companies into a costly detour around southern Africa.

— AFP

Brics nations condemn strikes on Iran; slam unilateral Trump tariffs

Joint statement also calls for permanent ceasefire in Gaza and release of hostages

RIO DE JANEIRO

Brics leaders at a summit on Sunday took aim at US President Donald Trump's "indiscriminate" import tariffs and recent Israeli-US strikes on Iran.

The 11 emerging nations — including Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa — account for about half the world's population and 40 per cent of global economic output.

The bloc is divided about much, but found common cause when it comes to the mercurial US leader and his stop-start tariff wars — even if they avoided naming him directly.

Voicing "serious concerns about the rise of unilateral tariff" measures, Brics members said the tariffs risked hurting the global economy, according to a summit joint statement.

In the joint statement, the leaders also agreed to denounce military strikes against Iran, a Brics member, since June 13, when Israel began attacks that culminated with US airstrikes nine days later.

Violation of law

The strikes "constitute a violation of international law and the Charter of the United Nations," according to the declaration.

"South Africa remains gravely concerned at the deteriorating peace and security situation in the Middle East," the country's President Cyril Ramapho-

TRUMP'S THREAT

US President Donald Trump threatened China, India, and some of the world's fastest-emerging economies with higher import tariffs, hitting back at Brics' criticism of his trade policies as the bloc met yesterday.

"Any country aligning themselves with the anti-American policies of Brics, will be charged an additional 10 per cent tariff. There will be no exceptions to this policy," Trump wrote on social media.

— AFP

sa told fellow leaders during his opening statement Sunday in Rio de Janeiro. "The recent attacks by Israel and the United States on the Islamic Republic of Iran raise serious concerns of international law, including the principles of sovereignty, territorial integrity and the protection of civilians."

The 11-member bloc of emerging-market nations also expressed "grave concern about the situation in the Occupied Palestinian Territory" — citing Israeli attacks and the obstruction of the entry of humanitarian aid into Gaza, something Israel denies — while calling for a permanent and unconditional ceasefire, along with the release of all hostages.

The summit also called for regulation governing artificial intelligence and said the technology could not be the preserve of only rich nations.

— Agencies

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